Generated from the competition table

1956 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1956, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner	National team	Ceremony date
Stanley Matthews	England	18 December 1956

The story of this edition

Stanley Matthews won the first-ever Ballon d'Or in 1956.

Next edition (PDF) →
1957

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →

📚 References & review

Status: verified Last reviewed:27 October 2026

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- **Gerd Müller Trophy (top scorer) - Harry Kane, his second trophy (source 2 of 3) (https://khelnow.com/football/ballon-dor-gerd-muller-trophy-winners-202610)
- **Gerd Müller Trophy (top scorer) - Harry Kane, his second trophy (source 3 of 3) (https://www.pulse.com.gh/story/full-list-of-gerd-muller-trophy-winners-from-2021-2026-20261026122450310 10)
- **Johan Cruyff Trophy (best coach) - Luis de la Fuente:** (source 1 of 3) (https://www.dazn.com/en-GB/news/football/ballon-dor-2026-winners-johan-cruyff-trophy-coach-of-the-year/7c3fvi1d49le1t1bv9xy76p0o)
- **Johan Cruyff Trophy (best coach) - Luis de la Fuente:** (source 2 of 3) (https://www.pulse.com.gh/story/johan-cruyff-trophy-winners-list-2024-2026-2026102612455241417)
- **Johan Cruyff Trophy (best coach) - Luis de la Fuente:** (source 3 of 3) (https://depor.com/en/us-live/2026-ballon-dor-winners-all-award-categories-and-recipients-nnda-nnrt-noticia/)
- **Sócrates Award (humanitarian) - Bukayo Saka:** (source 1 of 3) (https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/bukayo-saka-wins-socrates-award-220149187.html)
- **Sócrates Award (humanitarian) - Bukayo Saka:** (source 2 of 3) (https://www.goal.com/en/news/ballon-d-or-2026-bukayo-saka-wins-the-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work/blt56fa02ceffa40d5f)
- **Sócrates Award (humanitarian) - Bukayo Saka:** (source 3 of 3) (https://bolavip.com/en/soccer/what-is-the-socrates-award-at-the-2026-ballon-dor)

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.